and erasing circles. The circle would not stop saying "Rub this out, but carefully; it hurts," or "Draw me some hair, quickly, I look like a lollipop!" and other funny remarks.

After spending the whole afternoon together, Chris could now draw the little figure much better than most of his classmates. He was enjoying it so much that he did not want to stop drawing with this crazy new teacher of his. Before going to bed that night, Chris gave his new teacher a hearty thank you for teaching him to draw.

"But I didn't do anything!" answered the little drawing.

"Don't you see that you've been practising a lot, and enjoying it all the while? I bet that's the first time you've done that!"

Chris stopped to think. The truth was that he had drawn so badly because he had never practised more than ten minutes at a time. He had always done it angrily. So, what the little drawing had said was correct.



"You are correct, but, thank you," he said. He carefully kept the pencil in his school bag before going to sleep.

The next morning Chris jumped out of bed and went running to find his pencil, but it was not there. He searched everywhere, but there was no sign of it. The sheet of paper on which he had drawn the little figure, although still full of rubbing out marks, was completely blank. Chris was worried, and he did not know if he had spent the previous afternoon talking with the little man or whether he was dreaming all of it.

So, to settle the matter, he took a pencil and paper and tried to draw a little man.



Say whether he can draw well now. If yes, why?

It turned out not bad at all, except for a couple of rough lines. He imagined his little teacher telling him to rub and fix them. Chris gladly rubbed out those bits and redrew them. He realised that the crazy little teacher had been right: it made no difference whether you had the magic pencil or not.

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